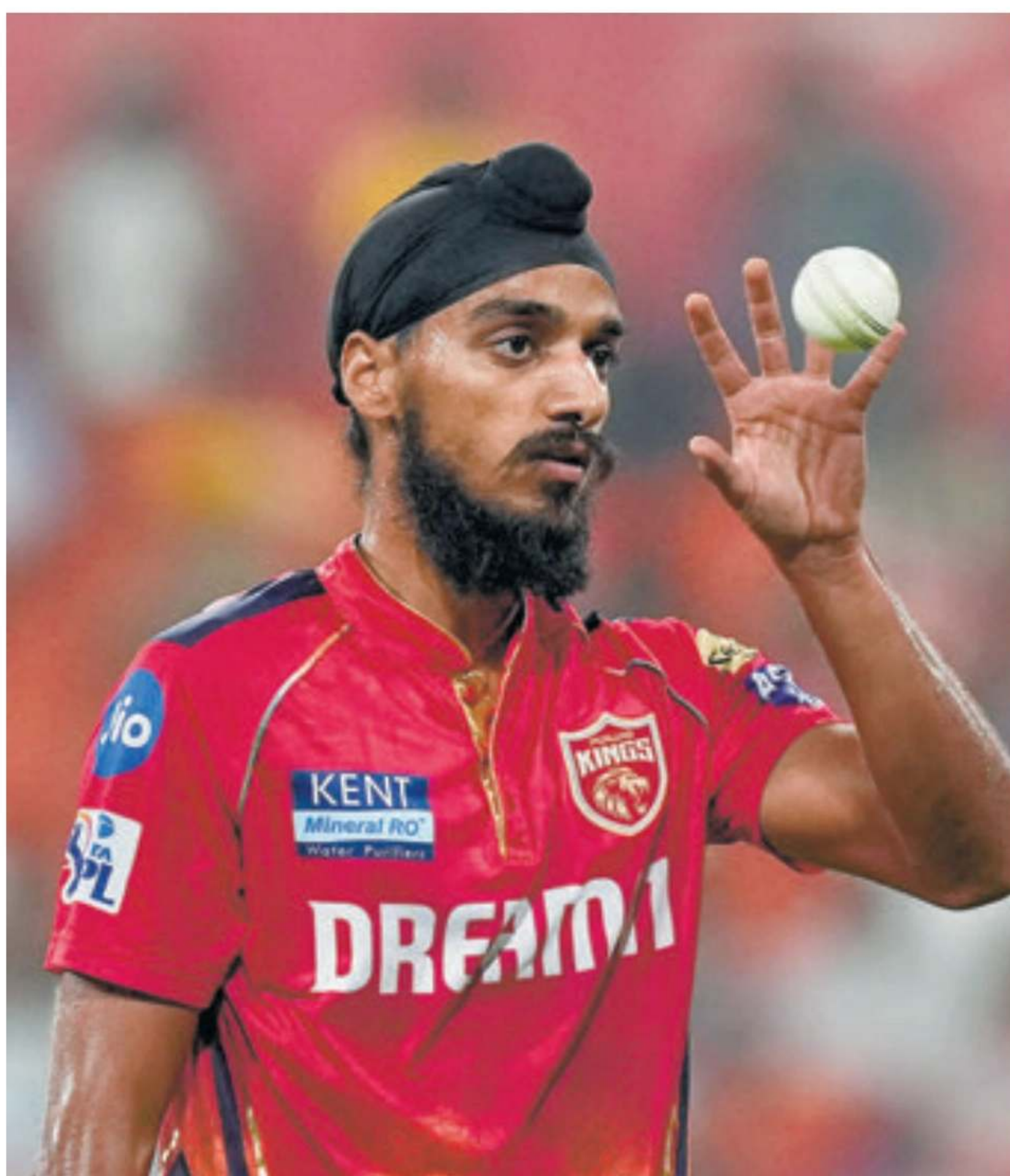


An expected windfall and all-rounders out of vogue

The modified Right-to-Match (RTM) rule significantly influenced the **auction dynamics** this year. Here are some key numbers.

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Breaking bank: Punjab Kings shelled out Rs 18 crore for Arshdeep Singh. "Left-arm fast bowler, obviously, with a great skill set with the new ball and the old ball and, you know, one of India's leading wicket-takers in T20 cricket. So he was a perfect fit for us to come back into the team," said head coach Ricky Ponting. PTI

The two-day Indian Premier League (IPL) mega auction, held in Jeddah, Saudi Arabia, witnessed a record-breaking windfall, with Rs 639.15 crore spent during the proceedings. Rishabh Pant (Rs 27 crore) and Shreyas Iyer (Rs 26.75 crore) emerged as the league's most expensive players, while the number of successful Rs 10 crore-plus bids doubled from the last auction. A total of 21 players were sold for Rs 10 crore or more, compared to just 11 during the previous mega auction in 2022.

The modified Right-to-Match (RTM) rule significantly influenced the auction dynamics. Under this rule, the highest bidder had the option to escalate their bid to an amount of their choice, allowing the previous franchise to match it. Beneficiaries of this provision included Rishabh Pant, Arshdeep Singh, and Naman Dhir.

Highest multiplier

Uncapped players often see their base price multiply dramatically in IPL auctions, and this time, Rasikh Salam Dar topped the chart. The J&K pacer was acquired by Royal Challengers Bengaluru for Rs 6 crore, a staggering 20 times his base price of Rs 30 lakh.

Though Rasikh made his IPL debut in 2019, he truly shone in the 2024 edition, impressing with his death-bowling skills for Delhi Capitals and taking nine wickets in 11 matches.

Overseas players

South African players were the most sought-after overseas cricketers in this auction, with 14 players picked by eight different teams.